These are not the only controversial points to arise in connexion with tea drinking, but they are sufficient to show how subtilized the whole business has become. There is also the **mysterious** social **etiquette** surrounding the teapot (why is it considered vulgar to drink out of your saucer, for instance?) and much might be written about the subsidiary uses of tea leaves, such as telling fortunes, predicting the arrival of visitors, feeding rabbits, healing burns and sweeping the carpet. It is worth paying attention to such details as warming the pot and using water that is really boiling, so as to make quite sure of wringing out of one's ration the twenty good, strong cups of that two ounces, properly handled, ought to represent.

(Taken from *The Collected Essays, Journalism and Letters of George Orwell*, Volume 3, 1943-45, Penguin ISBN, 0-14-00-3153-7)

About the Author

Eric Arthur Blair (25 June 1903–21 January 1950), better known by his pen name George Orwell, was an English novelist, essayist, journalist and critic whose work is marked by clear prose, awareness of social iniquity, opposition to totalitarianism and candid support of democratic socialism.



Orwell wrote literary criticism, poetry, fiction and polemical journalism. He is best known for the allegorical novella ***Animal Farm***(1945) and the dystopian novel ***Nineteen Eighty-Four*** (1949). In 2008, *The Times* ranked him second on a list of "The 50 greatest British writers since 1945".

Glossary

curious - interesting
controversial - arguable, disputable
virtues - admirable qualities
despised - hated
stimulation - excitement
optimistic - positive, hopeful
cauldron - a big pot used for boiling
rationing - restricting the consumption of a scarce commodity during war
dangling - hanging freely, suspended
spout - the pipe-like opening in a teapot through which tea is poured out
liable - likely
mysterious - incomprehensible
etiquette - socially acceptable behaviour

1. Based on your understanding of the text, answer each of the following questions in one or two sentences.

a) What seems 'curious' to the author?

b) Why does the author say that it is important to include a tea recipe in cookery books?

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